MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION NEWSLETTER

P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042

Hilton U. Brown, III - Editor



BARBEQUE SOCIAL & RAFFLE
The August Meeting

The August meeting will be our Second Annual Barbecue Social. The date is Sunday, August 13, 1995. Details are on page 3 of this Newsletter.

Judging by last year's event, an outstanding success! Good food!, Good company! A good time!

Don't miss this opportunity! Read page three and get your check in the mail! See you Sunday, August 13!

THIS 'N THAT
Meanderings from the editor

Steve Jones, Proprietor at THE PRINTING CLUB, 225 San Antonio Road, does most of the MVHA printing. Somehow or other I always seem to get the job to him at the last minute, but he always comes thru. He gives excellent advice, is always forgiving of the pressure, and his prices are more than competitive. I recommend THE PRINTING CLUB.

(more on page five)

SPANISH INFLUENCE
The May Meeting

Our speaker for the regular May, 1955, meeting of the Mountain View Historical Association was Dr. Chatham H. Forbes, a faculty member at the DeAnza College California History Center. Dr. Forbes joked that he was "issued" at the U.S. Military Academy at West Point, New York, but he moved to the area of Menlo Park and Palo Alto very young. His grandfather was the founder of the California Military Academy, established on the grounds of the old Mayfield Farm in 1924. The original farm building dated from 1853, and eventually became a beautiful mansion of some 40 rooms. The mansion burned down about 1932, contributing to the demise of the Academy.

There were two main themes to Dr Forbes presentation. The first was for the Mountain View Historical Association to join with the California History Center in some sort of project relating to Mountain View history. To this end he offered the services of the Center in coordinating research involving the Center's own resources, the resources of the Santa Barbara Mission Archives, and the Bancroft Library of the UC San Francisco. He also indicated that the Center was initiating a California Studies Program which might be of interest to the audience.

*(see - **Influence** - on page 2)*

*(from - **Influence** - on page 1)*

The second theme was an effort to refute what he referred to as the revisionist history of the missions in California. Dr Forbes blames the civil and military authorities for the brutalities inflicted upon the local Indians, and feels that the mission conflicts were largely due to the cultural shock incurred when two such different cultures as the civilized, Christian catholic fathers met with and tried to convert the gentile Indians.

It was unfortunate that Dr. Forbes did not spend more time discussing the Spanish Influence in the Santa Clara Valley, and what actually occurred as the two culture met, rather than trying to assess blame. No matter what the cause, a highly successful population of several hundred thousand native Americans was reduced to a few thousands in a a few decades, Spanish was established as the universal language, and Europeanized farming and ranching was established. Perhaps we can try to deal with this subject again in a future meeting.

TREASURER'S REPORT

April 1995 - June 1995

Our Treasurer, June de Larios, is out of town, and so we will defer a detailed report until the next issue of the Newsletter.

Bank Balance - June 30, 1995 $ 5,864.36

We gratefully acknowledge the cash donations from the following:

DeWitt Hogle
Arleen Redwine Fink

Slater (continued)

During his 40 years of service, Kenneth Slater worked loyally and enthusiastically as principal, coach and superintendent of the Mountain View School District. The children of this community benefited from his steady and dedicated leadership. For a further peek into his life, there is a display of pictures and memorabilia devoted to Kenneth Slater outside the Pioneer Room at City Hall.

KENNETH SLATER

Reported by Carol Fischer

Kenneth Norton Slater was one of the most beloved educational figures in Mountain View's past. He was an employee of the Mountain View School District for 40 years. Born in 1893 in Alturas, Modoc County, California, Kenneth was the youngest of Daniel and Jeanette Slater's three children. He and his family came to our area in 1904 and he graduated from Mountain View High School in 1912. Attending San Jose Normal School and Stanford University, Mr. Slater became Chief Administrator of the Mountain View School District in 1917. At this time the district comprised only two schools -- the Dana Street School and the Highway School -- with an enrollment of 275 pupils. Forty years later when Mr. Slater retired, there were seven schools and an enrollment of 2900 students.

At Mountain View High School, Kenneth was known as a studious athlete. He enjoyed playing football and baseball. In later years he recounted going to athletic events on the train. If a member of the team didn't have the train fare, he'd hide on the train and jump off just prior to the destination. Those games must have been very important!

Kenneth Slater was a man of many and varied interests. He joined the Navy in 1918. After returning from the service, he became director of the Chamber of Commerce, Commander of the American Legion and a district commander of the Boy Scouts. He also served as the president of the Santa Clara County Theater's Association. On top of these activities, he even had time to court, woo and marry Arline Bahls in 1923! The new Mrs. Slater was also a teacher. They settled into a home on Velarde Street.

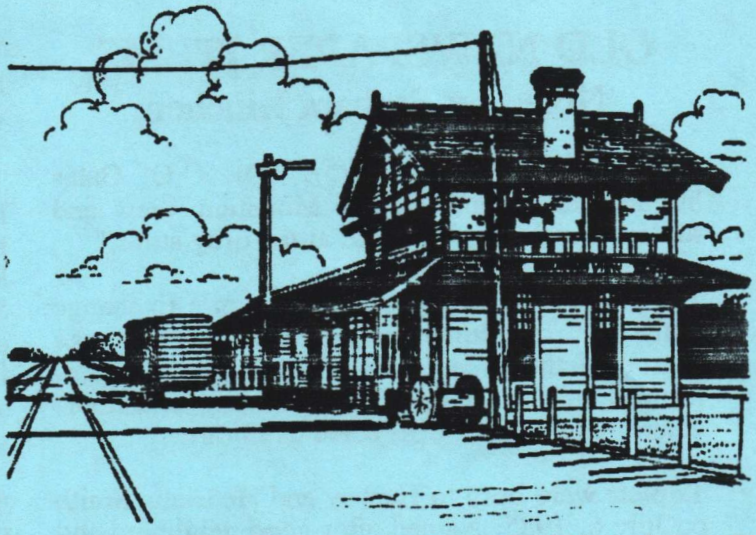
In 1956, shortly before Kenneth Slater retired, the District honored him by naming their new school on Whisman Road for him. After retirement, Kenneth and Arline traveled to Europe. Once at home, he remained active in the Mid-Peninsula Retired Teacher's Association. Mr. Slater died in 1971 at the age of 77.

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MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION

P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042

Sunday, August 13, 1995
Second Annual
Barbecue Social
Cuesta Park, Mountain View
Barbecue/Picnic Area



Southern Pacific Depot — Mountain View, California, built in 1888

MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION

Barbecue Social

and

Raffle

Sunday, August 13, 1995 -- 1:00 PM

Menu:

Hamburgers
Condiments
Green Salad
Potato Salad
Apple Pie

Bring your own:
Table Settings
Beverages

Cost:

Adults	$ 8.00 each
Children(under ten)	$ 5.00 each
Raffle tickets	$ 1.00 each
or 6 for	$ 5.00

Agenda:

1:00 PM	Registration
2:00 PM	Barbecue
3:30 PM	Raffle

(Approximate times)

Families and Friends Welcome!

Please call Edna Thompson at 967-3116 to reserve a place for your family and friends and mail your check by August 4, 1995 to:

MVHA Social
P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042

Any Questions? Any Volunteer Cooks? Any Volunteer Ticket Sellers? Just Want to Help? Call:
Wally Erichsen - (415)948 2644; Eva Mockbee - (415)967 6466; Edna Thompson (415)967 3116

OLD NEWSPAPER ITEMS
Noted by Barbara Kinchen

100 YEARS AGO (1895): "Dr. C.O. Gates has located permanently in Mountain View and for the present can be found at the drug store."

The W.C.T.U. has opened a Woman's Exchange in the Castro building and the ladies will also take charge of the Free Library and Reading Room, formerly in the Olympic Hall Building next door, where Judge B.E. Burns acted as librarian.

Triplets were born to Harvey and Henrietta Smith on July 6, 1985. Named after good neighbors and Mrs. Smith's Aunt Grace, Mary Agnes Grace Smith, Marguerita Valentine Grace Smith and Fracisca Chinita Grace Smith were so alike that red, white and blue ribbons were used for their identification. Friends collected money to help pay expenses, as this couple already had four other children and their last grain crop had been a failure.

The committee in charge of the Fourth of July Parade and Celebration raised more than enough money to pay expenses and voted the excess of $25.40 to be used toward buying a bell for the schoolhouse.

75 YEARS AGO (1920): "Even if you don't know the difference between right and wrong, the neighbors do."

An average of seven carloads of apricots a day are being shipped from Mountain View by Southern Pacific Company to various canneries in the state.

Orchard laborers are getting 57½¢ per hour. Lowland dairies are offering milk at 10¢ a quart.

Town Trustees are considering suing the San Jose Mercury for libel over a recent untruthful story on the condition of our streets.

You need suffer no longer, Fairyfoot Bunion Plasters are guaranteed to relieve.

Total enrollment at the high school was 114, with nine teachers. Eleven boys and eight girls graduated in June.

Population for the incorporated town was 1888, but the Post Office delivers to approximately 10,000 persons within a radius of 5 miles.

Yuen Lung has almost 100 employees picking, hauling, packing and shipping the $100,000 worth of fruit he contracted for this season.

The Pullman Cafe opened on Front Street (now Evelyn Avenue), near Hope Street, in what was formerly the private railroad car of Collis P. Huntington. Next door, the old Fashion Livery Stable building was being remodeled for a fruit conserving factory. Strawberry jam was to be the first project. Two planing mills, further along the same street, burned their shavings, causing more smoke than residents felt should be allowed.

50 YEARS AGO (1945): Police Chief A.H. Excell reported no hoodlumism nor intoxication on V.J. Day and thanked liquor establishments for closing, as had been requested by the Board of Equalization. However, there was plenty of noise from auto horn tooters, air raid sirens and firecrackers. One youngster had to be taken to Palo Alto Hospital after he accidentally stuffed a lighted punk into his pants pocket filled with firecrackers.

"Does your favorite restaurant have cockroaches? Tell them about Anderson's Pest Control Service."

One to four hospital planes each day fly into Moffett Field with patients for the Army's Dibble General Hospital in Menlo Park.

The assistant fire chief drove a pumper out to Loyola Corners, extinguished a burning stump and came back to the station pleased that the whole crew hadn't had to turn out. Almost immediately someone phoned and requested that he come over to Castro Street and pick up the 1,000 feet of hose strung out between El Camino Real and California Street. This was not a one-man job and so, chagrined Ed Demezzi had to blow the fire whistle to summon help.

25 YEARS AGO (1970): Construction projects started: Americana Apartments on El Camino near Dale Avenue, a circular-shaped building at 2465 Latham Street for Pacific Telephone's long distance operations and the 12 story International Environmental Dynamics Building at Castro and Mercy Streets. (Mountain Bay Plaza)

Council passed a budget of 10 million but held off approving a 5% tax on telephone and utility bills which the Chamber of Commerce strongly opposed.

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NEW TO THE PIONEER ROOM
Reported by Barbara Kinchen

From the Mockbee Family - Many interesting photos of local people, events and Mockbee family. Included are grammar school class pictures and one of Mountain View's float for a 1924 parade, featuring Miss Rae Mockbee as "Dutchess of Poppies". School children made the hundreds of paper poppies decorating this float.

From Marty Spangler - Newspapers: Special edition Los Altos Village Guide celebrating 1953 opening of Spangler Mortuary in Los Altos, 1958. Papers showing Martin J. Spangler, Sr. as "Man of the Year." Pictures: Spangler Mortuary 1935, ground-breaking ceremonies for firehouse on Villa Street in 1951.

From the Estate of Elda Fredrickson Black - Miscellaneous items, including programs, from Mountain View High School, San Jose State College and local musical events.

MORE THIS 'N THAT

Most residents of Mountain View receive the Mountain View Voice, our independent, bi-weekly newspaper. It's written and edited by and for Mountain View folks. Shirley Pearson has been writing a column called "From The Past" which is of special interest to MVHA members. Recent columns have described the "South Shore Port Baths", and early newspapers in Mountain View.

Old Newspapers (continued)

Three ounce packages of Jello sold for 9¢, 12 ounce cans of Canada Dry Soda were 10¢ and fresh salmon was priced at 79¢ a pound for half or whole and slices for 89¢ a pound.

IN MEMORIUM

Dorothy Petty Reel - April 28, 1995. Dorothy and her husband George operated a mobile home park and resort in Shasta City for a number of years and later worked with the Mobile Missionary Assistance Program, traveling to different parts of the country helping build churches, campgrounds and Christian Centers.

She was the daughter of the late Rollie and Leslie (Redwine) Petty and a cousin of our treasurer, June Redwine de Larios. Rollie Petty was Mountain View's Postmaster from 1933 until his retirement in 1964. Some time ago Dorothy gave us a number of snapshots showing postal employees and events and also an 8X10" photo taken May 19, 1938 at Mountain View Airport showing Mr. Petty beside a small plane which was taking a special bag of airmail to Mills Field, now San Francisco Airport.

HONORS

The City of Los Altos declared June 4, 1995 as Anna and Joe Fitz Day and honored the couple with a reception at History House. Anna Knapp Fitz, long-time member of the Mountain View Historical Association, is a painter and sculptress, using historical places and people as inspiration. She has used her Los Altos paintings and sculptured heads to teach school children about local history and has now donated these items to the Los Altos History House Museum.

STILL MORE THIS 'N THAT

"The 1906 Earthquake in Mountain View" by Barbara McPheeters Kinchen, with assistance from the Library and Mr. Jason Chan, is available in the Pioneer Room and will be available at the August 13 Barbecue.

EXPANSION PLANNED FOR THE PIONEER ROOM

The Pioneer Room is about to undergo a major expansion. With the cooperation and leadership of City Manager Kevin Duggan, Library Services Director Susan Ozubko and MVHA President Ralph Faravelli, the Pioneer Room will nearly triple its space on the fourth floor of City Hall. The new space will be comparable in size to the space the historical collections will occupy in the new library, when that building is completed in the future. The improved facility will allow space for the public exhibition of pictures, documents and other artifacts of old Mountain View and the area. It will greatly increase the accessibility of the historical materials for researchers, business people and students with a need to work with the historical records, and it will give the staff and Pioneer Room Volunteers the "elbow room" they need to carry on the work of preserving and cataloguing the archives of the area.

The Pioneer Room serves a number of important functions. For the Mountain View Historical Association, it is our archive. For the developer or builder, it is an early step in determining the suitability of a site for development. For the person seeking roots and origins, its the place to find out about the history of the area. For the City of Mountain View, it is our collective memory.

The Pioneer Room will be expanding into its enlarged quarters over the next few weeks. The library staff, with the leadership of Carol Fischer, and the Pioneer Room Volunteers led by Barbara Kinchen will be working hard to make the Pioneer Room an even more welcoming place for Mountain View residents and visitors.

EXECUTIVE COMMITTEE MEETING

June 3, 1995

Reported by Hilton Brown

The Executive Committee of the Mountain View Historical Association met at 10:00AM, June 3, 1995 at the Mountain View Library.

The Treasurer, June de Larios reported a Balance of $ 5,864.39. A motion was passed allowing the Treasurer to place the funds into an interest bearing checking account. The detailed membership report appears elsewhere in this newsletter. Wally Erichsen was appointed to chair the August 13 Barbecue Social. It was suggested that a time limit of 25-30 minutes be set for meeting speakers.

Ralph Faravelli reported on plans for the future Pioneer Room. Wally Erichsen reported on the status of the Castro station. The Historical Association Handbook is under development.

The complete minutes of the meetings of the Executive Committee are available to any member of the Association from either the Secretary or the Newsletter Editor.

And The End of This 'n That

Have you noticed the kind of support the Library Staff gives the MVHA? Not only do they do a very professional job in helping people use the facilities of the Pioneer Room, but they are a vital source of articles for the MVHA Newsletter. In recent issues of the Newsletter the following Library Staff Members have contributed articles:

Carol Fischer
Candace Bowers
Kathleen Lowe Owen
Loretta Jackson

Thank you all!

MEMBERSHIP REPORT

As of July 31, 1995

Reported by Edna Thompson

A list of all members of the Mountain View Historical Association is available from the Chair of the Membership Committee or from the Newsletter Editor.

Dues are $7.00 per year for an individual or $10.00 per year for a family and Life Membership is $100.00 per person.

Below is a tally by class of membership, and a list of the new members.

Life Members	30
Honored Member	1
Special Members	3
Family Memberships	47
Individual Members	118

Total Memberships	199
Total Members	247

New Members (Since the last Newsletter)

New Life Member

John W. Kirby

New Family Members

Estelle K. Balaty
John and Anna de Larios
Donald and Virginia Holt

Individual Members

John T. Buck
Juanita M. Camp
Elizabeth Seki

The following names were missed on the Roster:

Emma Traverso Luis
John and Edna Budesa Pear

ASSOCIATION OFFICERS AND BOARD

President	Ralph Faravelli
Vice President & Program	Arthur Walton
Secretary	Eva Mockbee
Treasurer	JuneDeLarios
Past President	Wally Erichsen
Membership	Edna Thompson
Newsletter & Publicity	Hilton Brown
Hospitality	Mary Esther Walton
Memorials/Rememberances	Ann Taylor
Ways & Means	Joseph Sweeney
Historical Data	Barbara Kinchen
Amplification & Recording	Albert Jehning
Social Activities	Margaret Vidovich

Regular meetings of the Mountain View Historical Association are held on the first Sunday of February, May, August and November. The Newsletter is mailed approximately two weeks before each meeting. Deadline for copy for the Newsletter is the third Sunday before each meeting. Short items on appropriate topics, submitted by any member of the Association will be considered for publication.

Life Members

(Those marked * are new life members in 1995)

Lorena Anderson*
Dena K. Bonnell*
Reynolds Camp*
Cliff Del Carlo
Wallace Erichsen
Carmen Farvelli*
Roger Fellows
Patricia Figueroa*
Marion Grimm*
Estelle Stagg Heffelfinger
Bill Henderson
DeWitt Hogle*
George Holden
George Jagels
Al Jehning
John W. Kirby*
Helen Shearer Krogh
Eva Mockbee*
Gail Urban Moore
Mimi Mourkas
Patricia J. Reyburn*
Elaine Marcetti Shearer
Martin J. Spangler*
Honor Spitz
Linda Swan
Joseph Sweeney
Roberta Sweeney
Edna Thompson*
John Viscovich*
Bill Wissell

MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION

Barbecue Social and Raffle

Sunday, August 13, 1995
1:00 PM

Cuesta Park
Barbecue/Picnic Area

Cuesta Drive, Mountain View
Details on Page 3
Inside

MEMBERSHIP

Any person who signifies their interest in the aims of this Association and who pays the specified annual dues may become a member of the Association.

AIMS The aims of this Association are: To gather and preserve historical data relative to the early settlement and development of the area in and around the present City of Mountain View; to collect, record, edit and publish a history of the pioneering activities of this area; to preserve historic objects and places. To cooperate with other organizations in the Santa Clara Valley on projects deemed worthy by our membership.

MEMBERSHIP APPLICATION

NAME _____

ADDRESS _____

_____

TELEPHONE _____

NEW ___ RENEWAL ___ Regular Membership $7.00/yr
Family Membership $10.00/yr - Life Membership $100.00
Make Check Payable and mail to:
Mountain View Historical Association
P.O. Box 252, Mountain View, CA 94042

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P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042

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